1.1 Origin and Growth of Statistics

The origin of statistics can be traced back to the primitive man, who put notches on trees to keep an account of his belongings. During 5000 BCE, kings used to carry out census of populations and resources of the state. Kings of olden days made their crucial decisions on wars, based on statistics of infantry, cavalry and elephantary units of their own and that of their enemies. Later it enhanced its scope in their kingdoms' tax management and administrative domains. Thus, the word 'Statistics' has its root either to Latin word 'Status' or Italian word 'Statista' or German word 'Statistik' each of which means a 'political state'. The word 'Statistics' was primarily associated with the presentation of facts and figures pertaining to demographic, social and political situations prevailing in a state/government. Its evolution over time formed the basis for most of the science and art disciplines. Statistics is used in the developmental phases of both theoretical and applied areas, encompassing the field of Industry, Agriculture, Medicine, Sports and Business analytics.

DO YOU KNOW?

The word 'data' was first used in 1640's. In 1946, the word 'data' also meant for "transmittable and storable computer information". In 1954, a term called 'data processing' was introduced. The plural form of 'datum' is 'data'. It also means "given" or "to give" in Latin.

In olden days statistics was used for political- war purpose. Later, it was extended to taxation purposes. This is evident from Kautilya's Arthasastra (324 – 300 BCE). Akbar`s finance minister Raja Thodarmall collected information regarding agricultural land holdings. During the seventeenth century, statistics entered in vital statistics, which is the basis for the modern day Actuarial Science. Gauss introduced the theory of errors in physical sciences at the end of eighteenth century.



Statistics is concerned with scientific method for collecting, organizing, summarizing, presenting, analyzing and interpreting of data. The word statistics is normally referred either as numerical facts or methods.

Statistics is used in two different forms-singular and plural. In plural form it refers to the numerical figures obtained by measurement or counting in a systematic manner with a definite purpose such as number of accidents in a busy road of a city in a day, number of people died due to a chronic disease during a month in a state and so on. In its singular form, it refers to statistical theories and methods of collecting, presenting, analyzing and interpreting numerical figures.

Though the importance of statistics was strongly felt, its tremendous growth was in the twentieth century. During this period, lot of new theories, applications in various disciplines were introduced. With the contribution of renowned statisticians several

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